

VP-INSTRUCTOR

Instructor / Benchmark Guide

Hidden ground truth, issue map, expected findings and scoring rubric

Entity	VertexPay Technologies Private Limited
Status	INSTRUCTOR ONLY - DO NOT DISTRIBUTE
Benchmark note	Synthetic record. Names and identifiers are fictional; statutory and regulatory sources are real.

This guide is not part of the participant case file. It supplies canonical synthetic facts where the benchmark designer intends a ground truth, identifies genuinely unresolved questions, and prevents scoring from rewarding invented certainty.

1. Case synopsis and hidden ground truth

VertexPay is a real-business-style but wholly fictional Mumbai fintech. Aarav and Nisha founded it in 2019. Meridian invested INR 120 million in November 2022. By August 2025 the Company faced a genuine liquidity crisis and a material Nimbus customer problem. Aarav made serious governance and documentation errors, but the available evidence does not establish that he stole Company money or personally received Vertex Labs payments. Meridian and Kavya used the crisis to accelerate a control shift through procedurally defective meetings and a selective distressed bridge. Both sides therefore have substantial merits and vulnerabilities.

- Canonical cap table: pre-Series A FD 8.0m; post-Series A 10.0m FD (9.5m issued/as-converted + 0.5m unallocated ESOP). Post-bridge: 14.5m issued and 15.0m FD before any ESOP top-up.
- Aarav owns 4.05m throughout: 40.5% post-Series A FD; 27.0% post-bridge FD; 27.93% of post-bridge issued voting capital.
- Meridian owns 2.0m before bridge and receives 4.0m: 40.0% post-bridge FD. Riverstone receives 1.0m: 6.67% FD.
- Bridge ground truth: INR 90m for 5.0m shares means INR 18.00 per share. Meridian signed a genuine, bridge-specific waiver of any clause 7 adjustment on 30 September. Its commercial logic is counter-intuitive in a control-shifting issue, the delegated-authority schedule is absent, and the EGM explanatory statement does not mention it. Strong models should query those matters; none alone proves invalidity.
- The bridge had a real commercial rationale. VP-18 is a selected extract, not a complete statement. Its selected rows plus an INR 12.2m net as-of reconciliation adjustment produce the reported INR 13.4m unrestricted cash figure at 9 September, but do not disclose the timing or gross composition of omitted movements. VP-05 reports INR 38.6m unaudited cash on 7 August while the selected-row reconstruction shows INR 44.9m; the basis, cutoff and restriction classification are unresolved. Payroll of INR 12.7m was paid on 30 September and INR 6.2m of statutory/other outflows remained

due or rolled. A funding solution was required, although the size, price and allocation remain contestable.

- No compliant 15-Business-Day pro rata offer was made. Nisha never waived pre-emption. Aarav proposed conditional funding at INR 60.00, not a committed September rescue on the INR 18.00 bridge terms.
- Kavya's spouse was a fixed-fee adviser to Riverstone, not an owner. This creates at least an appearance/conflict disclosure issue; it is not canonical proof of statutory related-party status or secret benefit.
- The INR 0.9m Riverstone shortfall was in fact withheld under a separate diligence mandate. The Company allotted fully paid shares before receiving that amount. There is no executed set-off agreement in the record.
- Aarav instructed payment splitting and misleading narration. He believed funds secured hardware. Vertex Labs produced real services/hardware worth at least INR 19.8m and refunded INR 3.2m. INR 1.1m remains unexplained after combining support/refund, but tracing is incomplete.
- Aarav's 'PA application in final review' email was inaccurate shorthand; Compliance immediately corrected it and Aarav accepted the correction. It supports carelessness and possible customer misrepresentation, not necessarily deliberate regulatory fraud.
- The 12 September minutes were reconstructed on 5 October. Rohan approved suspension on 15 September but never approved a fraud finding. The minutes' implication of contemporaneous digital signature and later 'unanimous' language are false or materially misleading.
- The bank mandate page was signed blank by Nisha on 11 September for contingency and dated before approval. Kavya knew the bank wanted it early. Activation occurred after the Board meeting, so authority and document-integrity questions are distinct.
- Aarav received incomplete 12 September materials and initially a broken/disabled-account link. A link was resent shortly before the meeting; non-attendance was not a clean refusal.
- EGM notice was sent to the register email but not SHA notice addresses, with a credible clear-notice issue. Aarav's full representations were not circulated and his waiting-room entry was deliberately not admitted after rapid voting.
- Nimbus never demanded Aarav's removal. It did have genuine compliance/log concerns and ultimately terminated after governance instability and incomplete remediation.
- No bad-leaver share transfer completed. The call notice alone did not change legal or beneficial ownership.

2. Canonical chronology

Date	Ground-truth event
2019-06-28	Company incorporated; Aarav 60%, Nisha 40% before seed financing.
2022-09-26	Series A term sheet signed at INR 60 per security; its valuation, investment amount and share count reconcile.
2022-11-18	Series A closing, SHA/employment/Articles adoption. SHA records INR 6 despite INR 120m for 2m securities. Hidden ground truth: INR 60 was the commercial price; INR 6 is a decimal drafting error. Bank received INR

Date	Ground-truth event
	120m.
2024-11-18	All founder reverse-vesting completed; later bad-leaver clause concerns vested shares only.
2024-12-15	Nimbus MSA signed.
2025-07-16/17	Aarav instructs split payments/narration; Finance and Nisha know at least part of the payments.
2025-08-07	Board flags cash, PA wording and Vertex Labs approval gaps. VP-05 records unaudited cash of INR 38.6m; VP-18's selected-row reconstruction shows INR 44.9m at 7 August. Basis and cutoff are unresolved.
2025-08-21	Aarav sends inaccurate PA-review wording; Compliance corrects same evening.
2025-08-25/26	Nimbus meeting; letter dated 22 Aug actually generated and sent 26 Aug.
2025-08-28	Board continues after Aarav leaves; forensic review approved; no misconduct finding.
2025-09-06	Meridian/Riverstone allocation discussed; Nisha does not waive; Rohan insists equal offer.
2025-09-08/09	Meridian special notice and Company EGM notice.
2025-09-10/12	Urgent Board notice, incomplete delivery, meeting, suspension/bridge/EGM/bank resolutions.
2025-09-15	Rohan approves suspension only; later minutes imply more.
2025-09-23	Aarav sends representations; full text withheld.
2025-09-30	EGM votes before Aarav joins; resolutions declared passed. Meridian signs a specific written waiver of clause 7 anti-dilution adjustment for this bridge.
2025-10-01	Board allots 5,000,000 shares at INR 18.00 each, terminates Aarav and issues bad-leaver call.
2025-10-03/04	Subscription receipts: INR 72m + INR 17.1m; shortfall persists.
2025-10-05	12 September minutes reconstructed.
2025-10-06/13/15	Notice and reply; EGM minutes signed/created on 15 October.
2025-10-20	Draft NCLT petition and IA.

3. Planted contradiction and issue inventory

ID	Issue	References	Expected finding
I-01	Definitive security price	VP-04 vs VP-01 / bank receipt	Term sheet INR 60 reconciles; SHA says INR 6 while still stating INR 120m for 2m securities. Hidden truth: SHA decimal error; participant should flag, not assume.

ID	Issue	References	Expected finding
I-02	Board quorum	VP-01 cl 3.2; VP-02 art 18; VP-05	SHA requires Founder 1; Articles do not. Corporate validity and inter se breach may differ.
I-03	Emergency notice	VP-01 cl 3.3; VP-05 C	Real emergency, but clause says emergency process cannot be used solely for financing; mixed agenda.
I-04	Conflict	VP-01 cl 3.4/4; VP-05; VP-08	Aarav conflict is real. It does not clearly erase his contractual consent. Kavya/Riverstone appearance issue also exists.
I-05	Minutes authenticity	VP-05 E; VP-15 Ex A	12 Sep minutes reconstructed 5 Oct; Rohan's approval overstated.
I-06	Bank mandate chronology	VP-05 C; VP-15 Ex B; WhatsApp	Form signed/dated before authority; activation after. Distinguish falsity from actual bank operation.
I-07	EGM notice	VP-06; VP-01 cl 15; VP-02 art 36	Different address regimes; clear-days and proof of delivery issues.
I-08	Removal representations	VP-06	Full representations received but not circulated; summary said to be read.
I-09	Waiting room	VP-06; WhatsApp	Aarav deliberately not admitted after unusually rapid vote; actual late arrival remains relevant.
I-10	Special resolution	VP-06	Supporters had 100% of votes cast if meeting valid. Percentage of total issued is not the statutory voting denominator for result.
I-11	Pro rata rights	VP-01 cl 6; VP-08	No formal offer; oral approach to Nisha and conditional Aarav proposal do not satisfy clause.
I-12	Cap-table denominator	VP-01 cl 2/7; VP-06; VP-17 workbook	Issued vs FD and ESOP treatment are mixed, producing 17.8%, 27%, 27.93%, and board-pack figures.
I-13	Subscription shortfall	VP-05 D; VP-12; VP-18 workbook	Allotment for INR 18m but receipt INR 17.1m; fee netting unsupported.
I-14	Bad Leaver	VP-01 cl 8; VP-03; VP-05 D	All shares vested; call not automatic; fraud not finally established; no transfer/payment/valuation.
I-15	Unanimity	VP-05 D/E; VP-08; VP-12	Rohan expressly dissented on fraud; 'unanimous' is wrong.
I-16	Vertex Labs quantum	VP-05/07/10/18	INR 24.1m paid; INR 19.8m support; INR 3.2m refund; INR 1.1m unexplained, subject to complete invoices.
I-17	Personal benefit	All financial records	No tracing to Aarav. Do not equate brother's firm plus poor process with proven embezzlement.
I-18	Nimbus notice date	VP-09; VP-15	Dated 22 Aug, generated/sent 26 Aug, references 25 Aug. Suspicious but explained as template dating error.
I-19	Nimbus demand	VP-05/08/09	Kavya says leadership change needed; Nimbus documents do not. Competing call notes are unverified.
I-20	Revenue recognition	VP-10	INR 31.5m booked without signed acceptance; MSA deemed-acceptance clause not produced.
I-21	Regulatory status	VP-01/07/09/10	No evidence VertexPay held live funds. Marketing risk is real; operating unlicensed PA is not established.
I-22	Electronic evidence	VP-07/08/15/16	Renders/text exports lack complete section 63 certificate, hashes or native custody.
I-23	Privilege	VP-08	Two investor-lawyer communications are facially privileged;

ID	Issue	References	Expected finding
			benchmark tests identification, not casual merits use.
I-24	Standing	VP-13/17	Aarav exceeds 10% on every plausible denominator; waiver under s244 is unnecessary.
I-25	Bridge issue price	VP-05/06/11/12/17/18	INR 90m divided by 5m shares is INR 18.00. Any INR 1.80 analysis is a material arithmetic error.
I-26	Anti-dilution waiver	VP-01 cl 7/16; VP-05 D; VP-17	On the executed SHA wording, INR 18 is not below the stated INR 6 conversion price. If the INR 6 drafting error is rectified to the commercial INR 60 price, the bridge would engage clause 7 absent waiver. Meridian specifically waived any adjustment in writing for this bridge, so no adjustment is modelled under either pathway. The missing delegated-authority schedule remains an authentication/authority point.
I-27	Board notice periods	VP-01 cl 3.3; VP-05 B-D	28 Aug had six calendar days; 12 Sep about 35h48m; 1 Oct about 15h50m. Section 173(3) requires seven days and permits shorter notice only for urgent business. The 12 Sep record states urgency; the 28 Aug and 1 Oct records do not. Rohan is a contractually appointed director, not shown to satisfy s149(6). The independent-director provisos therefore apply only if VertexPay had an independent director; if it did and none attended, decisions require circulation and ratification by at least one independent director, if any. Separately, SHA cl3.3 and Article 18.3 require seven days; the SHA emergency route requires 48 hours, an emergency statement and is unavailable solely for financing.
I-28	Access before authority	VP-05 C; VP-07; VP-15	Aarav account/access was disabled by 10 Sep, before the 12 Sep Board resolution. This affects employment process, preservation and whether service to the account was effective; identify who ordered the earlier action.
I-29	Preference voting rights	VP-01/02/06	Meridian voted its CCPS on an as-converted basis. Section 47(2) is relevant. Under G.S.R.

ID	Issue	References	Expected finding
			464(E), ss43 and 47 may be disapplied only where the memorandum or articles so provide; G.S.R. 583(E) further conditions the exemption on no default in filing financial statements under s137 or annual returns under s92. Complete constitutional documents and filing status are absent, so validity is deliberately unresolved.
I-30	Private placement record	VP-05/06/12-14/17/18	Test Companies Act ss42 and 62(1)(c), Share Capital Rules r13, Prospectus and Allotment Rules r14, valuation, identified offerees, PAS-4/PAS-5/PAS-3 and receipt/use of money. The file omits material records and shows a Riverstone shortfall; do not assume every defect has an identical remedy.
I-31	Face value and standing	VP-01/13/17	Face value is omitted, weakening a definitive s53 discount analysis and capital-based s244 calculation. Aarav nevertheless appears to satisfy s244 through the alternative member-count limb (one of five post-bridge members) and exceeds 10% on share-count/value assumptions used in the record.
I-32	Leena board status	VP-06; VP-05 D	EGM minutes appoint Leena director, but 1 Oct Board minutes list only three directors and do not invite or record Leena. Determine effective appointment, DIR-12 timing, notice and quorum implications.
I-33	Saffron proxy	VP-06; Companies Act ss105/113	Late deposit is a live issue. A body corporate is not barred per se from appointing a proxy: s105(6)(b) contemplates execution by an authorised officer/attorney; s113 is an alternative representation route.
I-34	Report and bank chronology	VP-10/15/18	The 10 Sep report cannot narrate the 18 Sep refund; corrected report records only the INR 4.3m gap at report date. The later bank record shows the INR 3.2m refund. Bank CSV export is 11 Oct, after statement end 10 Oct.

ID	Issue	References	Expected finding
I-35	Vertex Labs period label	VP-05 B; VP-10	The INR 9.6m figure spans 18 Jul, 22 Jul and 2 Aug. Treating it as purely August actual is a presentation/classification issue, not a new payment.
I-36	Selected bank extract and cash discrepancy	VP-05 A; VP-10; VP-18	VP-18 is not a complete statement. Its INR 12.2m net as-of adjustment reconciles selected rows to the reported INR 13.4m at 9 Sep but proves neither timing nor gross omitted flows. VP-05's INR 38.6m cash at 7 Aug conflicts with the INR 44.9m selected-row reconstruction. Cutoff, restricted cash, omitted offsetting flows and reporting error remain competing explanations.
I-37	Waiver commercial logic and disclosure	VP-05 D; VP-06; VP-17	Meridian's specific waiver is canonical and prevents a clause 7 adjustment in the corrected model. It is commercially counter-intuitive for a control-shifting bridge, its delegated-authority schedule is absent, and the EGM explanatory statement omits it. Give credit for querying authenticity, authority, motive and disclosure; do not treat suspicion alone as proof that the waiver is ineffective.
I-38	Early price knowledge and Meridian naming coincidence	VP-01; VP-05; VP-16	Aarav objects to INR 18.00 in the 6 September WhatsApp exchange before the 10 September board pack and 12 September resolution first formally record that price. This supports questions about advance knowledge or an omitted communication, but does not prove a leak or fabrication. 'Meridian Chambers' is the registered-office building name; the record establishes no connection to Meridian Growth Fund I. Treat the shared word as a potential entity-resolution trap, not evidence of affiliation.

4. Expected legal issues and verified authorities

Topic	Expected treatment
Oppression / mismanagement	Companies Act 2013 ss 241-244. Test requires more than isolated illegality; assess the course of affairs, prejudice/oppression and just-and-equitable dimension. Relief under s242 is broad. TCS Ltd v Cyrus Investments, Supreme Court judgment 26 Mar 2021, should be read directly and not reduced to a slogan.
Further issue and control dilution	Companies Act s62, the Articles and director duties under s166. Examine statutory approvals, purpose, valuation, disclosures and contractual pre-emption separately.
Director removal	Companies Act s169, including special notice and reasonable opportunity to be heard/representations. Also consider s115 and the facts of circulation and access.
Meetings and minutes	Companies Act ss100-102, 114-118, 173-175; SS-1 and SS-2 revised versions effective 1 Apr 2024 under s118(10). Do not assume a contractual defect automatically voids every corporate act.
Directors' conflicts/duties	Companies Act ss166, 184 and, where applicable, s188 and relevant rules. Related-party status and contractual 'related party' can differ.
Articles and SHA	Companies Act s10 and the actual wording of VP-01/VP-02. Score recognition that inter se contract enforceability, corporate authority and statutory validity require separate analysis.
Arbitration / NCLT	Arbitration Act ss8, 9, 11 and 16; SHA cl14. Apply the subject-matter and remedy analysis in Vidya Drolia v Durga Trading Corporation (Supreme Court, 2020/2021 judgment). Avoid a categorical claim that every shareholder dispute is or is not arbitrable.
Employment / restraints	Employment agreement and Contract Act s27; Specific Relief Act s14 may affect specific enforcement of determinable/personal-service obligations. Distinguish employment termination from removal as director and share rights.
Electronic evidence	Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam 2023 ss61-63 and statutory certificate schedule; IT Act ss4-5, 10A-13 as relevant. Identify authentication, completeness, hearsay/context and privilege separately.
Payment regulation	Payment and Settlement Systems Act 2007 and RBI Guidelines on Regulation of Payment Aggregators and Payment Gateways dated 17 Mar 2020, with subsequent modifications. Classify actual fund flow before alleging unauthorised PA operation.
Procedure	NCLT Rules 2016 rr34, 37 and 81; Form NCLT-1; verification in Form NCLT-6. The supplied petition is a benchmark draft, not a filing-ready substitute for local registry requirements.
Preferential/private placement	Companies Act 2013 ss42 and 62(1)(c); Companies (Share Capital and Debentures) Rules 2014 r13; Companies (Prospectus and Allotment of Securities) Rules 2014 r14 and prescribed PAS records. Test special resolution, identified offerees, registered-valuer pricing, offer/record/return documents, banking trail and full consideration separately.
Preference voting / private-company exemption	Companies Act s47(2); G.S.R. 464(E), 5 June 2015; and amending G.S.R. 583(E), 13 June 2017. The ss43/47 exemption requires the memorandum or articles to provide for it and no default in financial-statement filing under s137 or annual-return filing under s92. Both the complete constitution and filing status are absent, so state both conditions.
Issue below face value /	Companies Act ss53 and 244. Face value is not supplied, so no definitive s53

Topic	Expected treatment
standing	conclusion should be made. For s244, test both one-tenth of members and one-tenth of issued share capital with calls paid; the alternative member-count route matters.
Board notice	Companies Act s173(3) requires seven days' notice and permits shorter notice only for urgent business. Apply the independent-director attendance/ratification provisos conditionally: Rohan is not shown to be a s149(6) independent director. Keep statutory validity distinct from the SHA/Articles seven-day rule and the SHA's 48-hour emergency mechanism, notice-content requirement and financing restriction.

Primary-source links checked 31 August 2026

Companies (Share Capital and Debentures) Rules 2014 (India Code):

[https://upload.indiacode.nic.in/showfile?](https://upload.indiacode.nic.in/showfile?actid=AC_CEN_2_11_00014_199215_1517807319932&filename=1492085873402.pdf&type=rule)

[actid=AC_CEN_2_11_00014_199215_1517807319932&filename=1492085873402.pdf&type=rule](https://upload.indiacode.nic.in/showfile?actid=AC_CEN_2_11_00014_199215_1517807319932&filename=1492085873402.pdf&type=rule)

Companies (Prospectus and Allotment of Securities) Rules 2014 and official amendment trail (India Code Act/rules page):

<https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/2114?locale=en>

MCA private-company exemption notifications: G.S.R. 464(E), 5 June 2015:

https://www.mca.gov.in/Ministry/pdf/Exemptions_to_private_companies_05062015.pdf ; amended by G.S.R. 583(E), 13 June 2017:

<https://www.mca.gov.in/Ministry/pdf/ExemptionPrivateCompanies.pdf>

Current MCA PAS-3 instruction kit (ss39(4), 42(9), rr12 and 14):

https://www.mca.gov.in/content/dam/mca-af-forms/instruction-kits/Instruction_Kit_PAS-3.pdf

- Companies Act 2013 (India Code):
<https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/2114/5/A2013-18.pdf>
- NCLT Rules 2016 (NCLT): https://nclt.gov.in/sites/default/files/basicpage/Rules_NCLT_latest.pdf
- Arbitration and Conciliation Act 1996 (India Code):
<https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/1978/3/a1996-26.pdf>
- Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam 2023 (India Code):
<https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/20063/1/a2023-47.pdf>

- Indian Contract Act 1872 (India Code):
<https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/2187/2/A187209.pdf>
- Specific Relief Act 1963 (India Code landing page):
<https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/12938>
- Information Technology Act 2000 (India Code):
https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/13116/1/it_act_2000_updated.pdf
- ICSI SS-1 limited revision/current page: <https://www.icsi.edu/finalss1/>
- ICSI SS-2 revised effective 1 Apr 2024: https://www.icsi.edu/media/webmodules/Final_SS-2.pdf
- RBI PA/PG framework and escrow modification:
<https://www.rbi.org.in/scripts/NotificationUser.aspx?Id=11996>
- TCS Ltd v Cyrus Investments, Supreme Court judgment 26 Mar 2021:
https://api.sci.gov.in/supremecourt/2020/212/212_2020_31_1503_27229_Judgement_26-Mar-2021.pdf
- Vidya Drolia v Durga Trading Corporation, Supreme Court judgment 14 Dec 2020:
https://api.sci.gov.in/supremecourt/2018/26779/26779_2018_32_1501_25180_Judgement_14-Dec-2020.pdf

5. Facts supporting each side

Aarav / Petitioner	Company / Investor
Protected consent and formal pre-emption were bypassed; original Board quorum under SHA absent.	Real insolvency/payroll risk and Nimbus customer crisis required rapid funding.
Minutes reconstructed; Rohan dissent suppressed; wrong email/link and EGM exclusion.	Aarav knew about meeting, joined late, and had a conflict in investigation of related-party payments.
No proof of personal receipt or unauthorised live fund pooling; real vendor value/refund exists.	Aarav directed split payments/misleading narration, incomplete paperwork and inaccurate PA wording.
Bridge concentrated Meridian control and Riverstone had an appearance connection.	Price reflected distress; Meridian funded INR 72m and Riverstone substantially funded; all votes cast supported issue.
Bad-leaver process premature; no final fraud finding, valuation, transfer or payment.	Cause clauses exempt fraud from cure; evidence supported suspension and at least termination without Cause.
Nimbus did not demand removal; governance action worsened customer outcome.	Nimbus concerns pre-dated removal and revenue/log issues were material.

6. Deliberately ambiguous questions

- Whether the Articles/SHA quorum conflict makes the 12 September corporate resolutions void, voidable, or merely contractual breaches; answer depends on relief and full law/Articles analysis.
- Whether the EGM notice period and service were legally sufficient; facts support defects but the file omits complete dispatch infrastructure and any consent/waiver analysis.

- Whether the bridge issue was predominantly for capital rescue or control; both motives exist and purpose is evaluative.
- Whether Vertex Labs' remaining gap reflects missing invoices, overpayment or diversion; no final tracing evidence.
- Whether Nimbus deemed-acceptance permitted August revenue recognition; full MSA is deliberately absent.
- Whether Kavya's spouse relationship meets a statutory related-party definition; facts prove adviser relationship only.
- Whether privileged investor emails can be relied on, have been waived, or should be excluded; production circumstances are incomplete.
- Whether any contractual claims should be referred to arbitration while the NCLT retains statutory issues; avoid all-or-nothing answers.
- Appropriate final remedy: reversal, pro rata cure, governance regulation, or fair-value exit. The benchmark accepts reasoned alternatives.
- Whether the INR 38.6m/INR 44.9m 7 August cash difference reflects cutoff, restriction classification, omitted offsetting movements or reporting error; no complete bank statement is supplied.
- Whether Meridian's waiver was properly authorised and why it was commercially acceptable and omitted from the EGM explanatory statement; suspicion is appropriate, but invalidity is not established.
- Whether Aarav's 6 September reference to INR 18.00 reflects advance knowledge or a missing communication; and whether the shared word 'Meridian' in the office-building and investor names is merely coincidental. The file does not resolve either point.

7. Expected findings by common Legal AI task

Task	Minimum expected result
Chronology	Produce the core dates above; flag 22/25/26 Aug anomaly, 11/12 Sep mandate, 15 Sep approval vs 5 Oct creation, 30 Sep meeting/15 Oct minutes and funding after allotment.
Contract review	Identify clauses 3.2-3.4, 4, 6, 8, 14-16; Articles omissions/conflicts; employment cure/process; bad-leaver not automatic; post-employment non-compete risk.
Issue spotting	Cover corporate approvals, purpose/duties, oppression, removal, arbitration split, employment, related-party/conflict, regulatory classification, evidence/authentication, privilege and remedies. Include s42/private-placement records, s47 conditional voting rights, s53/face-value uncertainty, board short notice, pre-authority access disablement and Leena appointment.
Cap table	Use INR 18.00 issue price; reconcile 10m pre-bridge FD and 15m post-bridge FD; Aarav 27%; Meridian 40%; distinguish issued 14.5m and Aarav 27.93%. Identify 17.8% as unsupported. Apply the specific waiver without an anti-dilution adjustment, while querying its authority, commercial logic and omission from the EGM explanatory statement.
Financial analysis	Reconcile the selected rows and net as-of adjustment to the reported INR 13.4m

Task	Minimum expected result
	at 9 Sep without calling VP-18 complete; flag the INR 38.6m/INR 44.9m 7 Aug discrepancy and unknown gross omitted flows. Distinguish payroll paid from due/rolled outflows; test forecasts; flag Nimbus recognition, cost classifications, Vertex Labs 24.1/19.8/3.2/1.1 and the Riverstone 0.9 shortfall.
Evidence review	Separate admissions from allegations; demand native records, complete s63 certificate, hashes, device/server custody, Board video, valuation, subscription agreement, PAS-3 and full MSA.
Pleading analysis	Find standing satisfied; distinguish statutory from contractual/employment claims; evaluate interim preservation/status quo with business carve-outs; note missing filing evidence.
Legal notice drafting	Accurately state shareholding and alternative theories; preserve statutory/arbitration positions; avoid asserting theft, voidness or regulatory breach as established.
Investigation	Design interviews and document plan; do not treat family relationship or reconstructed document alone as dispositive; test both control-plan and genuine-rescue hypotheses.
Settlement	Model independent valuation/fair-value exit, governance standstill, evidence preservation, mutual narrative, employment dues and treatment of bridge/shortfall.

8. Scoring rubric (100 points)

Criterion	Points	Indicators
Document-grounded accuracy	20	Uses correct references; separates fact/allegation/inference; no invented record.
Chronology and contradiction detection	15	Finds material date, minutes, notice, payment and customer anomalies.
Corporate/company-law analysis	20	Sections 62, 166, 169, 241-244; meetings; Articles/SHA distinction; appropriate relief.
Contract and forum analysis	10	Correct clauses, employment/share separation, nuanced arbitration/NCLT split.
Financial and cap-table accuracy	15	Uses INR 18.00; correct denominators/percentages and reconciliations; applies but critically evaluates the specific waiver; treats VP-18 as incomplete; identifies the 7 Aug cash discrepancy, unknown omitted gross flows and payment shortfalls without formula errors.
Evidence, privilege and investigation	10	Authentication/custody/certificate gaps; privilege handled; balanced investigation plan.
Practicality and remedies	5	Proportionate interim/final solutions protecting business and parties.
Communication quality	5	Concise, prioritised, precise, appropriate uncertainty.

Penalty guidance

- -10 or more: invents a case, statute, missing document or decisive fact.
- -8: gives a materially wrong cap table or treats 17.8% as correct without qualification.
- -5 each: asserts proven embezzlement; asserts Nimbus demanded removal; asserts completed bad-leaver transfer; or ignores the documented liquidity evidence without engaging with material counter-evidence or forecast uncertainty.
- -5: uses facially privileged communications without identifying privilege issue.
- Cap at 60: one-sided analysis that ignores material contrary evidence.
- Cap at 50: fails to distinguish statutory NCLT relief from contractual/arbitration claims.

Performance bands

Score	Band
90-100	Expert: precise, balanced, source-anchored and numerically correct
75-89	Strong: finds most issues with minor omissions
60-74	Competent: useful but incomplete or weakly prioritised
40-59	Weak: material misses, arithmetic/forum/evidence errors
0-39	Unreliable: invented or materially wrong conclusions

9. Instructor administration

Recommended participant tasks: chronology and issue spot; contract and cap-table review; NCLT merits/interim analysis; evidence admissibility and investigation plan; settlement memo; or cross-document contradiction audit. Set scope and expected output length in the task prompt; the benchmark does not prescribe a default time limit. Do not distribute this guide or instructor ZIP. If a task excludes legal research, score only against authorities supplied or propositions framed conditionally.